

Atonement, Under the Law

This document focuses on **Atonement under the Law** in the Old Testament, specifically through sacrifice and the role of priests.

- Atonement was made by **sacrifice**, with the laying of hands on the head of the burnt offering, followed by the killing of the animal and the sprinkling of blood around the altar by Aaron's sons.

- This act was carried out by **priests alone**, who were appointed for all the work of the most holy place to make atonement for Israel, as commanded by Moses.

Atonement was necessary for:

- **Propitiating God** and seeking forgiveness for sins.
- **Ransoming** or redeeming souls.
- **Purifying** and sanctifying.

Atonement was offered for:

- The **Congregation** as a whole
- The **Priests** themselves
- **Individuals** who sinned **ignorantly** or **willfully**
- **Specific situations** like swearing rashly, withholding evidence, being unclean, women after childbirth

- The **Altar** and the **Holy Place**
- The **Healed Leper** and the **Leprous House**
- **Extraordinary cases** where the community as a whole needed atonement

The document emphasizes that these practices and rituals under the Law were **typical of Christ's Atonement**, foreshadowing the ultimate sacrifice and redemption through Jesus Christ

in the New Testament. This connection is supported by a quote from Romans, highlighting Christ's death for the ungodly and the justification and salvation offered through His blood.

Made By Sacrifice.

Leviticus 1:4-5. And he shall put his hand upon the head of the Burnt Offering; and it shall be accepted for him to make Atonement for him. And he shall kill the bullock before the LORD: and the priests, Aaron's sons, shall bring the blood, and sprinkle the blood round about upon the altar that is by the door of The Tabernacle of the Congregation.

By Priests Alone.

1 Chronicles 6:49. But Aaron and his sons offered upon the altar of the Burnt Offering, and on the Altar of Incense, and were appointed for all the work of the place most holy, and to make an Atonement for Israel, according to all that Moses the Servant of God had commanded.

2 Chronicles 29:24. And the priests killed them, and they made reconciliation with their blood upon the altar, to make an Atonement for all Israel: for the king commanded that the Burnt Offering and the Sin Offering should be made for all Israel.

NECESSARY FOR

Propitiating God.

Exodus 32:30. And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses said unto the people, Ye have Sinned a great Sin: and now I will go up unto the LORD; peradventure I shall make an Atonement for your Sin.

Leviticus 23:27-28. Also on the tenth day of this seventh month there shall be a day of Atonement: it shall be an Holy Convocation unto you; and ye shall Afflict Your Souls , and offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD. And ye shall do no work in that same day: for it is a day of Atonement, to make an Atonement for you before the LORD your God.

2 Samuel 21:3. Wherefore David said unto the Gibeonites, What shall I do for you? and wherewith shall I make the Atonement, that ye may bless the inheritance of the LORD?

Ransoming.

Exodus 30:15-16. The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less than half a shekel, when they give an offering unto the LORD, to make an Atonement for your souls. 16

And thou shalt take the Atonement money of the children of Israel, and shalt appoint it for the service of The Tabernacle of the Congregation; that it may be a memorial unto the children of Israel before the LORD, to make an Atonement for your souls.

Purifying.

Exodus 29:36. And thou shalt offer every day a bullock for a Sin Offering for Atonement: and thou shalt cleanse the altar, when thou hast made an Atonement for it, and thou shalt anoint it, to sanctify it.

OFFERED FOR

The Congregation.

Numbers 15:25. And the priest shall make an Atonement for all the Congregation of the children of Israel, and it shall be forgiven them; for it is ignorance: and they shall bring their offering, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD, and their Sin Offering before the LORD, for their ignorance:

2 Chronicles 29:24. And the priests killed them, and they made reconciliation with their blood upon the altar, to make an Atonement for all Israel: for the king commanded that the Burnt Offering and the Sin Offering should be made for all Israel.

The Priests.

Exodus 29:31-33. And thou shalt take the ram of the consecration, and seethe his flesh in the holy place. And Aaron and his sons shall eat the flesh of the ram, and the bread that is in the basket, by the door of The Tabernacle of the Congregation. And they shall eat those things wherewith the Atonement was made, to Consecrate and to sanctify them: but a stranger shall not eat thereof, because they are holy.

Leviticus 8:34. As he hath done this day, so the LORD hath commanded to do, to make an Atonement for you.

Persons Sinning Ignorantly.

Leviticus 4:20-35. And he shall do with the bullock as he did with the bullock for a Sin Offering, so shall he do with this: and the priest shall make an Atonement for them, and it shall be forgiven them. And he shall carry forth the bullock without the camp, and burn him as he

burned the first bullock: it is a Sin Offering for the Congregation. When a ruler hath Sinned, and done somewhat through ignorance against any of the commandments of the LORD his God concerning things which should not be done, and is guilty; Or if his Sin, wherein he hath Sinned, come to his knowledge; he shall bring his offering, a kid of the goats, a male without blemish: ...

Persons Sinning Wilfully.

Leviticus 6:7. And the priest shall make an Atonement for him before the LORD: and it shall be forgiven him for any thing of all that he hath done in trespassing therein.

Persons Swearing Rashly.

Leviticus 5:4. Or if a soul swear, pronouncing with his lips to do evil, or to do good, whatsoever it be that a man shall pronounce with an Oath, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then he shall be guilty in one of these.

Leviticus 5:6. And he shall bring his Trespass Offering unto the LORD for his Sin which he hath Sinned, a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats, for a Sin Offering; and the priest shall make an Atonement for him concerning his Sin.

Persons Withholding Evidence.

Leviticus 5:1. And if a soul Sin, and hear the voice of swearing, and is a Witness, whether he hath seen or known of it; if he do not utter it, then he shall bear his iniquity.

Leviticus 5:6. And he shall bring his Trespass Offering unto the LORD for his Sin which he hath Sinned, a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats, for a Sin Offering; and the priest shall make an Atonement for him concerning his Sin.

Persons Unclean.

Leviticus 5:2-3. Or if a soul touch any unclean thing, whether it be a carcase of an unclean beast, or a carcase of unclean cattle, or the carcase of unclean creeping things, and if it be hidden from him; he also shall be unclean, and guilty. Or if he touch the uncleanness of man, whatsoever uncleanness it be that a man shall be defiled withal, and it be hid from him; when

he knoweth of it, then he shall be guilty.

Leviticus 5:6. And he shall bring his Trespass Offering unto the LORD for his Sin which he hath Sinned, a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats, for a Sin Offering; and the priest shall make an Atonement for him concerning his Sin.

Women After Childbirth.

Leviticus 12:8. And if she be not able to bring a lamb, then she shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons; the one for the Burnt Offering, and the other for a Sin Offering: and the priest shall make an Atonement for her, and she shall be clean.

The Altar.

Exodus 29:36-37. And thou shalt offer every day a bullock for a Sin Offering for Atonement: and thou shalt cleanse the altar, when thou hast made an Atonement for it, and thou shalt anoint it, to sanctify it. Seven days thou shalt make an Atonement for the altar, and sanctify it; and it shall be an altar most holy: whatsoever toucheth the altar shall be holy.

The Holy Place.

Leviticus 16:16-17. And he shall make an Atonement for the holy place, because of the uncleanness of the children of Israel, and because of their transgressions in all their Sins: and so shall he do for The Tabernacle of the Congregation, that remaineth among them in the midst of their uncleanness. And there shall be no man in The Tabernacle of the Congregation when he goeth in to make an Atonement in the holy place, until he come out, and have made an Atonement for himself, and for his household, and for all the Congregation of Israel.

The Healed Leper.

Leviticus 14:18. And the remnant of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall pour upon the head of him that is to be cleansed: and the priest shall make an Atonement for him before the LORD.

The Leprous House Healed.

Leviticus 14:53. But he shall let go the living bird out of the city into the open fields, and make an Atonement for the house: and it shall be clean.

Extraordinary Cases Of.

Exodus 32:30-34. And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses said unto the people, Ye have Sinned a great Sin: and now I will go up unto the LORD; peradventure I shall make an Atonement for your Sin. And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, Oh, this people have Sinned a great Sin, and have made them gods of gold. Yet now, if thou wilt forgive their Sin--; and if not, blot me, I pray thee, out of thy book which thou hast written. And the LORD said unto Moses, Whosoever hath Sinned against me, him will I blot out of my book. ...

Numbers 16:47. And Aaron took as Moses commanded, and ran into the midst of the Congregation; and, behold, the plague was begun among the people: and he put on incense, and made an Atonement for the people.

Numbers 25:10-13. And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, hath turned my wrath away from the children of Israel, while he was zealous for my sake among them, that I consumed not the children of Israel in my jealousy. Wherefore say, Behold, I give unto him my covenant of peace: And he shall have it, and his seed after him, even the covenant of an everlasting priesthood; because he was zealous for his God, and made an Atonement for the children of Israel.

Typical of Christ's Atonement.

Romans 5:6-11. For when we were yet without strength, in due time Christ died for the ungodly. For scarcely for a Righteous man will one die: yet peradventure for a good man some would even dare to die. But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us. Much more then, being now justified by his blood, we shall be saved from wrath through him. ...